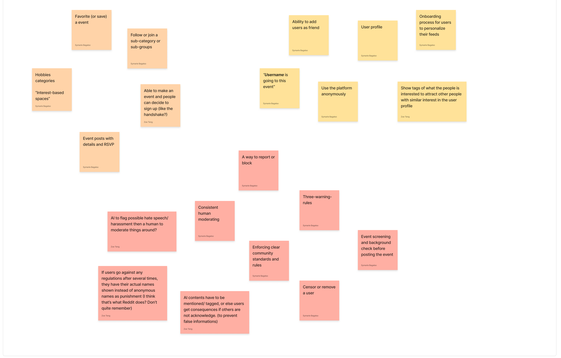

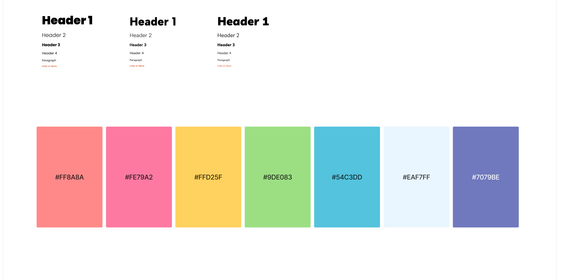

HMW

How might we create an online space for the LGBTQIA+ where they can connect and create long-term connections with one another in-person.

Empathy Map

Says

"I do not trust any of the social media companies CEO! They only care about how their speech would affect their stocks! They do nothing for the community!"
Zoe Teng

Online groups are more harm than good.
Nicole Adler

I connect wth happy, positive people.
Nicole Adler

I'm lucky to have friends who are well connected within the LGBTQ community
nealen bonifacio

Internet not reliable and too much AI
Fernando Salgado Coronado

Wants "meeting place for art and activities"
Fernando Salgado Coronado

I wish there were more resources for older members of the LGBTQ community
Katelyn Ang

I should look online for resources about LGBTQ events
nealen bonifacio

Thinks

No one should be threatened for who they are
Nicole Adler

Sharing cultures would be a nice way to connect with one another

I think there's less resources for older generations compared to young adults
nealen bonifacio

I'm very lucky that I made some good friends who accept me. There are many people out there being threatened/ harassed.
Katelyn Ang

LGBTQ+ people are still harrassed at a much higher rate than other groups.
Zoe Teng

This source is written with AI, it's probably not trustworthy.
Katelyn Ang

Every platform should have a moderator
Nicole Adler

Having a standard for behavior is important to create a safe community
nealen bonifacio

Does

Volunteers to non-profit LGBTQIA+
Symarie Bagaloo

Removed themselves from social media. (due to harassment)
Symarie Bagaloo

Reports obvious hate-based remarks.
Symarie Bagaloo

Actively messages friends and talk with them on phone.
Symarie Bagaloo

Sometimes will look online for information about medical care, financial aid, etc.
Symarie Bagaloo

Connects with people mostly in-person.
Symarie Bagaloo

Goes to community events.
Nicole Adler

Check references to ensure online information accuracy.
Symarie Bagaloo

Feels

Politeness and kindness makes me feel safe
Zoe Teng

The rich people do not give a damn about people who doesn't make them rich.
Zoe Teng

People who get away with hate speech would be encouraged to continue if not interffeared.
Zoe Teng

Mostly safe because he's older and doesn't participate much anymore
Nicole Adler

Education is key, ot enough people are on the topic.
Nicole Adler

Lots of innocent comments out there being flagged as hate speech
Katelyn Ang

Online platforms are not reliable for a friendly community
Fernando Salgado Coronado

Brainstorming Features

Favorite (or save) a event
Symarie Bagaloo

Follow or join a sub-category or sub-groups
Symarie Bagaloo

Ability to add users as friend
Symarie Bagaloo

User profile
Symarie Bagaloo

Onboarding process for users to personalize their feeds
Symarie Bagaloo

Hobbies categories

"Interest-based spaces"
Symarie Bagaloo

*"**Username** is going to this event"*
Symarie Bagaloo

Use the platform anonymously
Symarie Bagaloo

Show tags of what the people is interested to attract other people with similar interest in the user profile
Zoe Teng

Able to make an event and people can decide to sign up (like the handshake?)
Zoe Teng

Event posts with details and RSVP
Symarie Bagaloo

A way to report or block
Symarie Bagaloo

Three-warning-rules
Symarie Bagaloo

Consistent human moderating
Symarie Bagaloo

AI to flag possible hate speech/ harassment then a human to moderate things around?
Zoe Teng

Enforcing clear community standards and rules
Symarie Bagaloo

Event screening and background check before posting the event
Symarie Bagaloo

Censor or remove a user
Symarie Bagaloo

If users go against any regulations after several times, they have their actual names shown instead of anonymous names as punishment (I think that's what Reddit does? Don't quite remember)
Zoe Teng

AI contents have to be mentioned/ tagged, or else users get consequences if others are not acknowledge. (to prevent false informations)
Zoe Teng

F&N-F Reqs and MoSCow

Functional	Non-functional
Community meetups to go to or host (online or in person)	Clean and easy navigation
Sharing of art	Good moderators that look after users
Resources for events nearby	Soft vibrant color theme
Knowledge of history of LGBTQ	Simple, consistent interface across all screens
User profiles	
Resources for health, housing, and school	Strong privacy protections and secure user data
Option to have anonymous profile	Fast loading time and smooth performance
An online space where people can vent	
Match up with a buddy to talk to	
Discussion boards on different subjects	
Enforcing clear community standards	

Must Have	Should Have	Could Have	Won't Have
Community meetups to go to or host (on the app)	Favorite (or save) an event	Soft vibrant color theme	Posts about NSFW (Gore, Intimate)
Background check and verification	Option to have anonymous profile	Knowledge of history of LGBTQ	Storing User Data. Everyone is safe
Resources for events nearby	User profiles	Sharing of art	No assuming genders, that is what identification is for
Onboarding process tailored to user	Match up with a buddy to talk to	Age Restriction	No Mocking anyone's opinion
Clean and easy navigation	A friend list	Media Recommendations	No non moderated public chat rooms
Enforcing clear community standards	Chat Log	matchmaking or friend recommendation features	
Good moderators to look after users	Clear, visible reporting tools	IP account ban, so no other accounts from the same ip can be made	
Event posts with details and RSVP			
Resources for health, housing, and school			

User Persona

Mathew Reed

Age: 25
Pronouns: They/Them
Location: Northern California
Occupation: Freelance Graphic Designer

Bio

Mathew Reed is a vibrant non-binary individual who recently moved to Northern California. They deeply value community, self-expression, and inclusion. While searching for local LGBTQIA+ events, Mathew finds that most platforms are outdated, fragmented, or not truly centered on the queer community.

Mathew wants a single, reliable place where he can discover inclusive events from casual meetups and drag shows to volunteer opportunities and pride celebrations. They are hoping to meet new friends and build a sense of belonging in his new city.

Personality

Introvert — Extrovert
Planner — Spontaneous
Cautious — Adventurous
Independent — Community
Homebody — Explorer
Private — Open
Low-Energy — High-Energy

Goals

- An easy way to find local queer-friendly events
- Host a queer-friendly hiking event with new friends
- Meet like-minded people, and support LGBTQ-owned businesses and events

Frustrations

- Is unsure whether certain places are unsafe
- Resources are scattered
- Online communities are too open allowing toxicity

Name Idea

Color Language
Symarie Bagaloo

Happy
Symarie Bagaloo

Jolly (synonym)
Symarie Bagaloo

Smile

inspiration from Mitch
Symarie Bagaloo

Chirpy
(synonym)
(birds of a feather flock together; finding community)
Symarie Bagaloo

Rainbow
Symarie Bagaloo

Smiling faces! People who look past race, age, social and economic status, and just focus on being decent human beings. There is no substitute for being polite and kind.
Symarie Bagaloo

Diverse
Symarie Bagaloo

LGBTQIA+

Chill
Katelyn Ang

Pride
Zoe Teng

Friendly
nealen bonifacio

Name Idea: PrideSpace
Zoe Teng

Gather
Zoe Teng

HappyHours - 1
Polari - !!!
Jolly - 1
Chirpy - 3
RainbowSpace - 2
PrideSpace - 2
Flock - 2
Symarie Bagaloo

Name Idea: Rainbow Space
Katelyn Ang

Name Idea: Polari (form of slang used in gay subculture in the UK)
nealen bonifacio

Meet up
Zoe Teng

Branding

Header 1
Header 2
Header 3
Header 4
Paragraph
Links or More

Header 1
Header 2
Header 3
Header 4
Paragraph
Links or More

Header 1
Header 2
Header 3
Header 4
Paragraph
Links or More

#FF8A8A	#FE79A2	#FFD25F	#9DE083	#54C3DD	#EAF7FF	#7079BE